Babur and Kābul. Babur was becoming increasingly anxious about Kābul. No arrangements were made to face the cold till that point. No quarters were allocated either, so Babur decided to make a move from Herī.

Losing all hope, Babur along with his men got out of town on 24 December of AD 1506. On the pretext of finding the winter quarters, Babur and his men went near Bādghīs. They were riding so slow that the moon of Ramzan could be seen only a few marches beyond the Langar of Mīr Ghiyāṣ.[23] Many of Babur's men had been absent on various occasions but now almost all had come out. Some of them joined Babur, while some followed him to Kābul after three weeks. Some stayed back in Herī submitting themselves to the service of Mīrzās. One among them was Sayyidīm 'Alī the gate-ward who went on to become Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā's retainer. Babur's behaviour towards him had been exceptional given that he had not been so generous to any servant of Khusrau Shāh. He had been given Ghaznī at the time when Jahāngīr Mīrzā abandoned it. But when he became the retainer of Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā, he gave the responsibility of Ghaznī to his younger brother Dost-i-anjū Shaikh.[*]

> There were in truth no better men amongst Khusrau Shāh's retainers than this man Sayyidīm 'Alī the gate-ward and Muḥibb-i-'alī the armourer. Sayyidīm was of excellent nature and manners, a bold swordsman, a singularly competent and methodical man. His house was never without company and assembly; he was greatly generous, had wit and charm, a variety of talk and story, and was a sweet-natured, good-humored, ingenious, fun-loving person. His fault was that he practiced vice and pederasty. He may have swerved from the Faith; may also have been a hypocrite in his dealings; some of what seemed double-dealing people attributed to his jokes, but, still, there must have been a something!

But when Badī'u'z-zamān Mīrzā had let Shaybāni Khān take control of Herī, he had gone to Shāh Beg. By doing so, he had disposed Sayyidīm 'Alī into Harmand. It was a double deal struck between the Mīrzā and Shāh Beg.

Babur and his men guided themselves past the border villages of Gharjistān[24] to Chach-charān[25] the Langar of Mīr Ghiyāṣ. There lay a continuous thick blanket of snow right from the almshouse to Gharjistān. It kept deepening as they moved further. Near the Chach-charān the snow reached the horses' knees.

Chach-charān was now in control of Ẕū'n-nūn Arghūn. When Babur and his men reached, Ẕū'nnūn's retainer Mīr Jān-aīrdī was in control of the place. Babur took the whole provision store of Ẕū'n-nūn Beg as payment.

They began to march further but only to find the route turning worse. The snow now reached above the stirrup. Babur has said in the *Baburnama* that, 'indeed in many places the horses' feet did not touch the ground'.